

Windows Media Center

Released in 2002, Window Media Center was Microsoft's solution for a unified media consumption utility. Unfortunately, the painful setup procedure, outdated interface, and competition from other software like XBMC (now Kodi) and NextPVR is what led Microsoft to eventually discontinue support for it. If you are part of the very niche group still using Media Center, consider switching to an alternate, especially if you plan on upgrading to Windows 10.

Solitaire, Hearts, and Minesweeper

Windows 8 users have already been heartbroken by the absence of these iconic time wasters, and it seems Microsoft still sees no need to add preloaded games to Windows 10. However, you can still the official version of Solitaire and Minesweeper from the app store. Just be ready to deal with annoying ads, which for some bizarre reason, can be removed by paying \$1.49 a month. Good luck making money with that tactic, Microsoft.

That's all nice, but this is Windows we're talking about. Surely there are some reasons why I should not upgrade.

You don't want to be a software guinea pig

Despite its long development cycle, Windows 10 is still a relatively untested operating system. And like any software, it is always best to wait a while till after it has been tested on multiple systems with different hardware-software combinations. Before upgrading, make a list of all the applications you use and check if they are compatible with Windows 10. If not, it would be best to wait till the developers push out a compatible versions or till a Windows updates fixes it. Though as you have learnt from the previous chapter, most software won't have any issues with compatibility.

You own old peripheral hardware

Chances are that if you own decades-old peripherals like printers and scanners, you may have already given this a thought. Windows is infamous for not ensuring the compatibility of present day drivers with vintage devices, mainly because the trade-off between effort taken to ensure compatibility and number of users that actually use old hardware is not very profitable. So before you hit the upgrade button, do some research as to whether that old printer has drivers compatible with Windows 10. If you're out of luck, your options would be to either to upgrade Windows and switching to new